

9fin

MCP Agent

September 2026

Credit Coverage: Time Intensive, Completed by Time Poor Analysts

- Investment banking analysts have a huge amount of work to do and not enough time to do it
- Ongoing coverage tasks within a restructuring or LevFin team often go neglected, despite being essential to business development and fundamentally winning deals
- Screening companies takes time. In any given week, for an analyst within an RSSG group they typically spend:
 - ~30-40 minutes reading about a company's business model
 - >1 hour pulling and entering key financials
 - ~30-60 minutes building the capital structure, pulling pricing data and holders
 - ~30 minutes crafting a view on key triggers
 - ~30 minutes recreating a corporate structure
- **This work is typically done in the hours after midnight** and may be required for several companies in a given week
- Consequently, this is often done poorly with the bare minimum effort or neglected completely
- An agent that can screen for new names, distill which are more interesting and then prepare a tear-sheet that can be used to discuss a credit with a senior banker will not only save several hours per week but also increase a team's coverage of the market significantly

The Solution: A 9fin-enabled Research Analyst

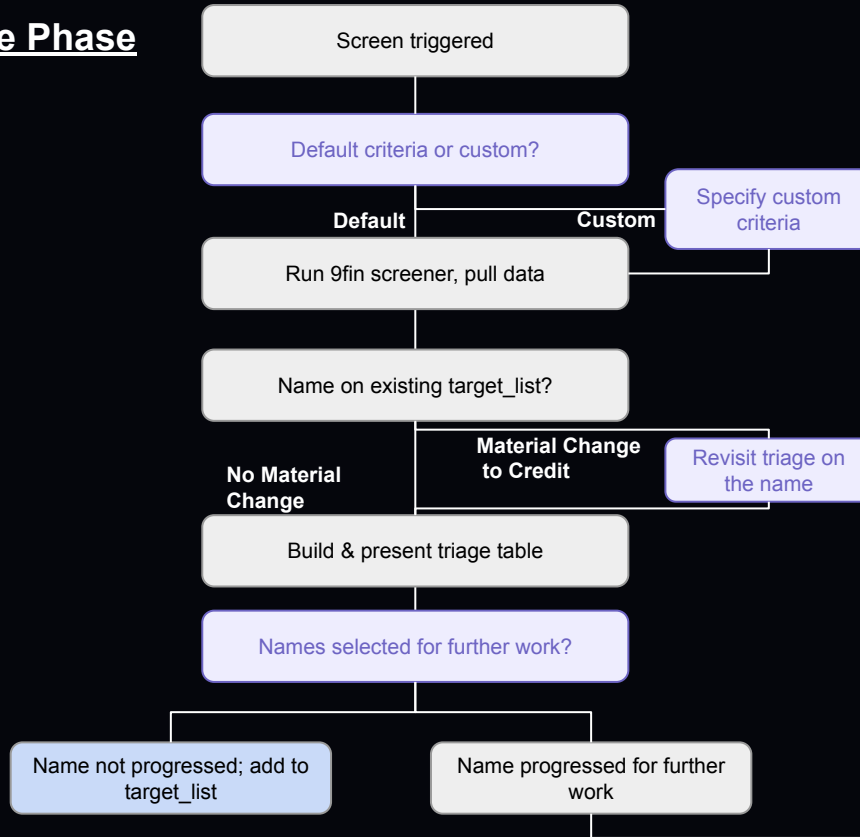
- A 9fin-enabled Claude agent approaches the task in the following steps:
 - a. Runs a screen on 9fin based on a defined criteria
 - b. The Claude agent then triages the list and recommends credits to do further work
 - c. Once selected, the Claude agent then deploys sub-agents specialised in (i) Capital Structures, (ii) Financials and (iii) News. The agents collaborate to build a tearsheet on the selected companies using 9fin's proprietary data
 - d. Once built, the output is returned for review. If approved a pdf is generated
 - e. An email is drafted, summarising the screen - ready to send to a senior banker. If approved, the agent then sends the email
 - f. Once sent, the agent then proceeds to summarise findings of the screen into a target list csv file, which it refers to for future screens

Wagamama UK pan-Asian casual dining — Wagamama BondCo Limited (E330m 8.5% SSNs 2030)			Prepared for internal use — CMCK Associates Last updated: 27-Sep-2026 Coverage: B2 (Moody's, reg.) / B (S&P, reg.)	
SECTOR / INDUSTRY Consumer Discretionary — Restaurants	COUNTRY United Kingdom (86% of revenue)	COMPANY TYPE Private, sponsor-owned bond issuer	TICKER n/a — unlisted	
OWNERSHIP / SPONSOR Apollo Global Management (via TRG)	LAST UPDATE DATE 27-Sep-2026	COVERAGE STATUS 9fin covered; S&P report reviewed 28-Jun-26	RESTRICTED GROUP Wagamama BondCo / Wagamama (Holdings) Ltd No trigger currently active. Liquidity is the primary live concern (conditional S&P "adequate" rating, negative FOCF through FY26) and the RCF's springing covenant is approaching activation (37.6% drawn vs. 40% threshold) — both warrant quarterly monitoring. No near-term maturity wall (SSNs due Jun-2030).	
WATCHLIST — MONITOR				
BUSINESS DESCRIPTION Wagamama is the UK's largest pan-Asian casual dining chain, operating a single "Wagamama" brand across noodle- and rice-based dishes, small plates and drinks, positioned as an affordable, health-focused alternative within UK casual dining. The first restaurant opened in Bloomsbury, London in 1992. As at FY2025 year-end, the estate comprised 166 owned UK & Ireland restaurants, six owned US sites, and 54 franchised sites (primarily Europe and the Middle East), plus an early-stage 50%-owned India joint venture. Revenue mix: 95-98% of revenue is generated by UK & Ireland company-operated restaurants. Dine-in remains the largest channel; delivery (Deliveroo since 2016, Uber Eats added Q2 2026) represents c.19-21% of UK sales, guided by management to reach c.25% on a run-rate basis by end-2026. Average main-meal price was £15.49 (FY2024), reflecting a deliberate value-volume positioning. Under IPSE the group discloses one reportable operating segment. Corporate history: The Restaurant Group plc (TRG) acquired Wagamama in 2018 at c.12.2x EBITDA, making it TRG's largest brand within a wider multi-brand estate (Frankie & Benny's, Chiquito, Brunning & Price, TRG Concessions) that was progressively rationalised through the following years. Apollo Global Management completed a take-private of TRG on 29-Dec-2023 to £707m EV, c.6x EBITDA. In January 2025, as part of a refinancing, Apollo split TRG into three standalones, separately-financed divisions — Wagamama, Pubs (Brunning & Price) and Concessions — each sitting under Rock BondCo Limited. Wagamama's restricted group issued £330m of 8.5% Senior Secured Notes due 2030 to refinance a prior sterling unitranche facility. In July 2026, TRG sold its Concessions division (88 airport sites, c.£240m revenue) to Areses Group. Wagamama continues to trade in UK airports as a franchisee of Areses.				
THE WAGAMAMA / TRG PERIMETER The £330m SSNs and £50m RCF sit in a Wagamama-only financing also issuer: Wagamama BondCo Limited; guarantors: Wagamama (Holdings) Limited and Wagamama Limited, legally and structurally separate from TRG's Pubs and Concessions also — confirmed independently by both 9fin's org chart/CMO and S&P's recovery analysis. Apollo owns all three sites in parallel via Rock BondCo (~96.1%), not through a TRG-controlled chain sitting over Wagamama. That said, operational integration persists: Mark Chambers is CFO of TRG and CEO of Wagamama, both he and TRG CEO Andy Homby present under TRG titles on bondholder calls, and TRG Holdings continues to recharge Wagamama for shared services (c.£9-12m/year) under an uncapped restricted-payments basket — a value-leakage risk flagged by 9fin's legal analysis. No shareholder loan/PK is currently on file above the restricted group, but Wagamama Topco and Wagamama Midco sit structurally outside it, which is latent (unconfirmed) headroom for one to sit there invisibly to reported leverage. See Group Structure (p.2) for the full chart.				
SITUATION OVERVIEW				

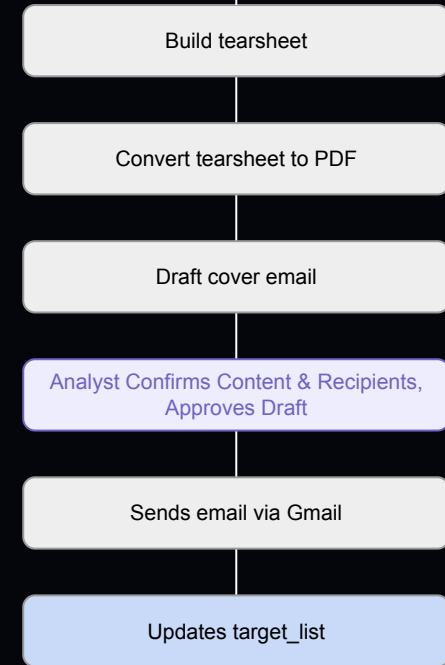
Figure 1: Sample Output from a screen of Wagamama

Illustrative Agent Workflow

Triage Phase



Execution Phase



Key

Analyst Input Required

Agent Workflow

Workflow End Node

Potential Impact

- The screen has the potential to (i) significantly reduce manual analyst workload, (ii) expand the coverage universe and (iii) Leave more time for judgement rather than data gathering
- Empirically speaking an email summary produced by an analyst within the PJT RSSG team would take 5-6 hours minimum and would have significantly less information
- Proactive screening reduces the risk of missing target credits - replacing manual Sunday/Monday triage with an automated weekly screen completed by the Claude agent by Monday morning, ready for analyst direction.
- Analysts can continue to work on important deal work while Claude runs in parallel with user input only required for key decision nodes
- Importantly, the user trusts the data because it's all 9fin data

Limitations

- **Pricing:** A key parameter in most screens run is current trading of TLB / Bonds. This is a significant limitation as pricing is often a leading indicator (~12 - 18 months) ahead of a restructuring transaction. Additionally, pricing helps frame the recent developments and situation summary. It must be noted, during one of the screens, one of the agents actually cross-referenced against the price decliners in 9fin's "Top of the Flops" segment when making the initial triage assessment
- **Holders:** Stakeholders are key in the analysis of credits. It tells the banker which credit funds they must speak to, to gain intelligence on a particular credit. The lack of available holdings data adds in a second manual input into the process, alongside the pricing data.
- **Financials Data Gaps:** The screener can sometimes overlook / miss companies with private financials, which can limit the agent's ability to effectively triage information